

JOHNSON MUGARRA

Research and Data Consultant, Technical Lead Consultant, Research Associate
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Research and data consultant with experience across proposal development, applied research, and field data systems. At the Center for Research and Communication, coordinated proposals and provided technical leadership for evaluations covering design, sampling, tools, data quality, analysis, and reporting. At Enimiro, built and maintained SurveyCTO to PostgreSQL data pipelines, dashboards, and farmer data systems. Conducted vanilla value-chain research on harvest timing with Makerere University, MAAIF, and partners. Earlier work includes process evaluation support at Innovations for Poverty Action, qualitative field research for USAID SITES, and research assignments at Bronkar.

CORE SKILLS

- Statistical software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, SAS, SPSS, Excel
- Research and evaluation: survey design, piloting and translation, computer-assisted interviewing, key informant interviews, focus group discussions, transcription
- Data collection and quality: questionnaires, tablet-based collection, enumerator training and supervision, validation, back-up and documentation
- Visualization and reporting: Power BI, Tableau, dashboards, donor-ready reports
- Data systems: SurveyCTO API, PostgreSQL, Google Sheets, ETL pipelines, GeoPandas
- Proposal development: concept note, strategy, design, methodologies and work plans, budgeting, quality assurance

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research and Data Consultant, July 2026 - January 2027

Enimiro Products Uganda Ltd, Kayunga, Uganda

- Coordinated with the data team to collect, clean, and organize operational data on farmer activities, crop production, sales, and sustainability programs.
- Maintained a Python pipeline moving SurveyCTO submissions into PostgreSQL raw, clean, and analysis tables, with photo handling and scheduled exports to Google Sheets for dashboards.
- Matched GPS records to district boundaries and maintained the farmer master with merge and change logs for auditability.
- Built and maintained dashboards and reports tracking performance indicators for management and the board.
- Ran statistical and trend checks to highlight risks and opportunities and translated findings into training manuals and field guidance.
- Supported crop productivity and supply-chain research, updated survey tools and monitoring forms, trained staff on data use, and documented methods for donor and certification reporting.

Technical Lead Consultant, January 2025 - June 2026

Center for Research and Communication (CRC), Remote

- Reviewed client requirements and evaluation criteria to shape proposal strategy and coordinated inputs across team members and specialists to meet deadlines.
- Wrote and edited technical sections, including methodologies and work plans, and worked with finance to align technical approaches with compliant budgets.
- Provided technical leadership for the IRC MERP endline evaluation, covering evaluation design and tools, data analysis and synthesis, and integration of qualitative and quantitative findings against the results framework.
- Led quantitative inputs for IRC baseline and perception studies, including sampling strategy, instrument testing, data-quality checks, and statistical analysis with visual summaries.
- Served as data and M&E lead for UNICEF behavior-change and community awareness studies, covering tools, trackers, datasets, reach analysis, and report drafting.

Researcher / Data Scientist, Vanilla Value-Chain Research, January 2024 - June 2025

Makerere University with MAAIF, Catholic Relief Services, and private sector partners, Uganda

- Researched vanilla maturity and harvest timing to inform national harvest-declaration considerations, combining field and crop work with statistical modelling.
- Integrated field, satellite climate, and survey data and built time-series models to compare maturity-assessment methods and their timing, quality, and price implications.

- Applied thermal-time analysis based on accumulated growing degree days to link heat units to crop development through maturity.
- Conducted farmer and stakeholder interviews, field measurements of development stages, and seasonal maturity assessments across vanilla-growing districts.
- Helped establish the Kabanyolo demonstration plot and prepared models, scenario notes, and technical inputs for supervisors and stakeholders. Work concluded with program funding closure.

Research Associate, February 2023 - November 2023

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA), Kampala, Uganda

- Supported development and implementation of process evaluation plans with program managers.
- Designed survey instruments and supported piloting, translation, and computer-assisted interviewing.
- Coordinated evaluation logistics including timelines, field staffing, and procurement, and managed data entry, cleaning, and analysis.
- Applied data-quality protocols including enumerator audits and monitoring of data collection.
- Maintained partner relationships, contributed to stakeholder meetings and reports, and supported research approvals and compliance.

Qualitative Research Associate, July 2023 - March 2024

Social and Scientific Systems for USAID Strategic Information Technical Support (SITES), Uganda

- Completed training on field methods and tools and managed questionnaires and tablets for fieldwork, with deployments concentrated in Eastern and Northern Uganda.
- Assessed facility readiness for transition to Health Information Exchange and paperless viral load requests, including review of UgandaEMR versions in HIV clinics against ART registers, ART cards, and viral load registers for demographics, identifiers, ART start dates, and latest results.
- Conducted key informant interviews and focus group discussions with data clerks, data officers, clinicians, counselors, and laboratory staff, and checked data quality across HMIS tools and the EMR.
- Documented practical constraints affecting EMR use such as DHIS2 user knowledge, internet stability, power supply, computer performance, and notifications, and shared facility-level feedback at the close of each visit.
- Compiled progress and activity reports with safe back-up, storage, and transmission of collected data. Completed a 12-day assessment from 18 to 29 September 2023 within a seven-region exercise covering Kigezi, Ankole, Lango, Acholi, Busoga, Bugisu, and Karamoja.

Research Associate, September 2021 - January 2023

Bronkar (U) Limited, Kampala, Uganda

- Developed assignment workplans with the supervisor and tracked deliverables across research assignments.
- Designed and refined methodologies and survey tools for qualitative and quantitative collection for field use.
- Trained enumerators and participated in field research including interviews and structured surveys.
- Cleaned and analyzed survey data and prepared insights and conclusions for client reports and proposals.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Data Science, September 2022 - October 2024

Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE), Karnataka, India

B.Sc. Agricultural Science, September 2016 - May 2021

Makerere University, Kampala, Uganda

CERTIFICATIONS

SAS Certified Statistical Business Analyst
 Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate
 Tableau Desktop Specialist
 Google Project Management Certificate
 Human Subjects Research (CITI)

REFERENCE

- Gloria Ayesiga, Supervisor at IPA, gayesiga@gmail.com, +256759252676
- Ronald Kagiri, Supervisor at Bronkar, rkagiri@gmail.com, +256782665971